TOGETHER, WE RISE

Jefferson High School

Enrollment Update

Purpose

Engage in a strategic discussion about potential solutions to stabilize and grow Jefferson High School's enrollment. While previous efforts have fallen short of delivering equity and clarity, this conversation is intended to surface ideas, not make decisions.

With a full modernization underway, we have a unique opportunity to reset, rebrand, and reestablish Jefferson as a thriving, high-demand neighborhood school for North Portland.



For Context: Resolution No. 4358

For more than a decade, PPS has operated a dual assignment procedure for Jefferson High School, allowing students to choose between Jefferson and neighboring high schools. While intended to offer flexibility, this policy has led to under-enrollment at Jefferson, overcrowding at other schools, and confusion for families.

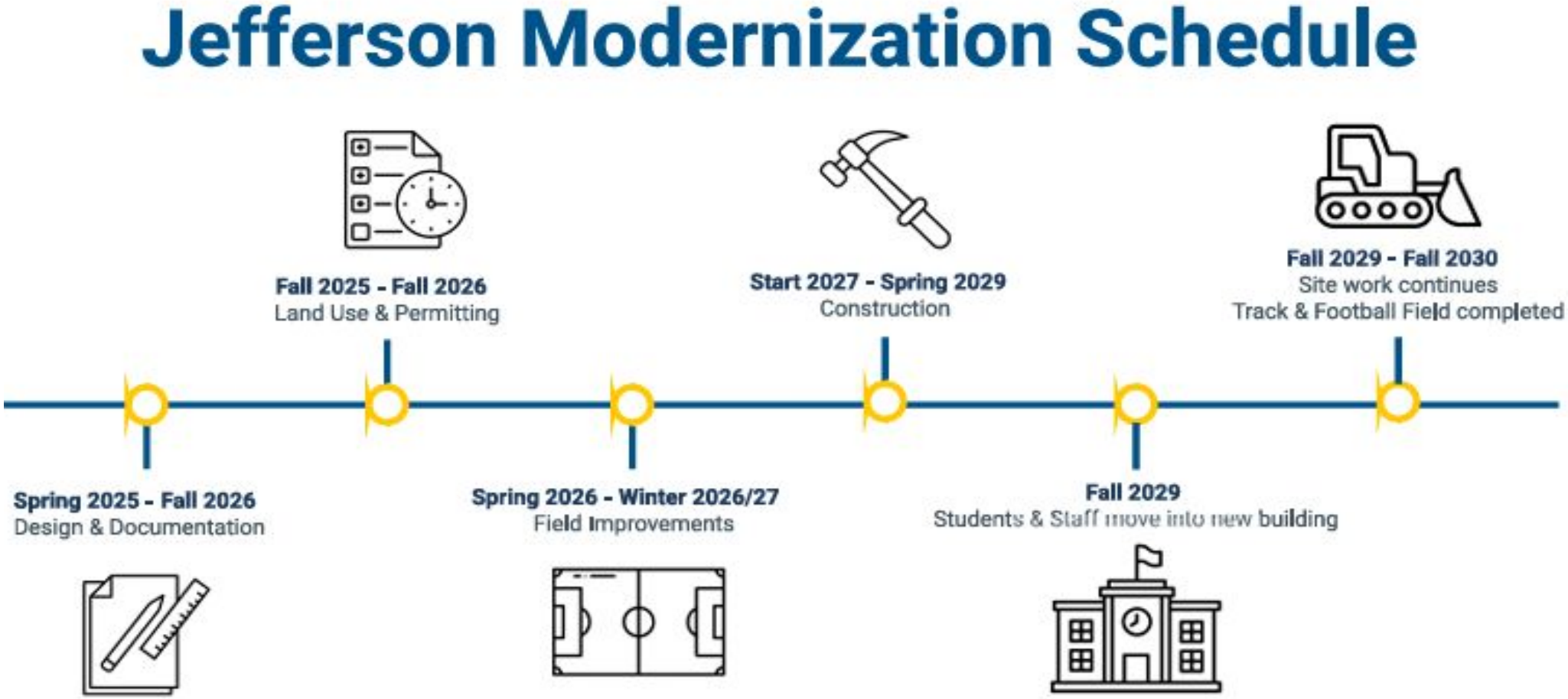
In Board **Resolution No. 4358** (December 2022), the Board directed the district to resolve Jefferson's student assignment structure by 2027—aligned with a historic modernization investment.

In response, PPS proposes a community dialogue beginning Fall 2025 to consider sunsetting dual assignment and reestablishing Jefferson as a comprehensive neighborhood high school, ensuring equitable access, enrollment clarity, and long-term stability for students and schools.

Building Jefferson, Together

Enrollment Objectives

Strengthen student population during modernization | Ensure robust long-term enrollment at Jefferson



Jefferson Dual Assignment

2024-25 HS Enrollment			
Dual Assignment High Schools	Dual Assignment Students	All Other Students	Total
Jefferson HS	381	78	459
Grant HS	699	1450	2149
McDaniel HS	197	1489	1686
Roosevelt HS	462	990	1452
Total	1739	4007	5746

Main Method for Jefferson Enrollment

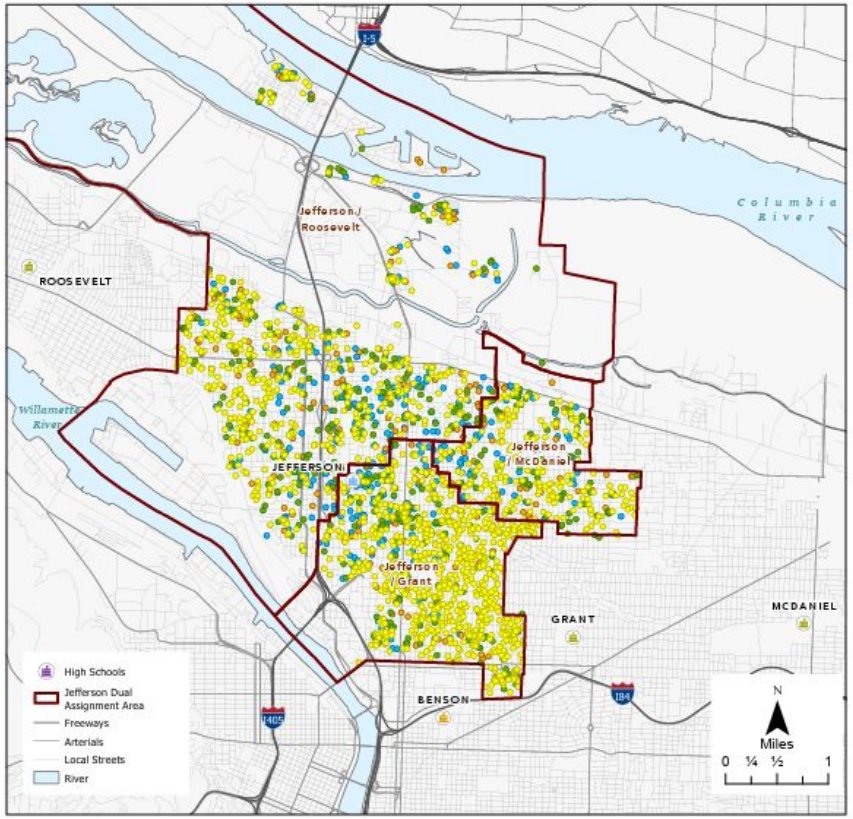
Resolution 4394, 2011

8th graders choose Jefferson or another high school based on their home address

***Comprehensive Options:**

- Grant
- McDaniel
- Roosevelt

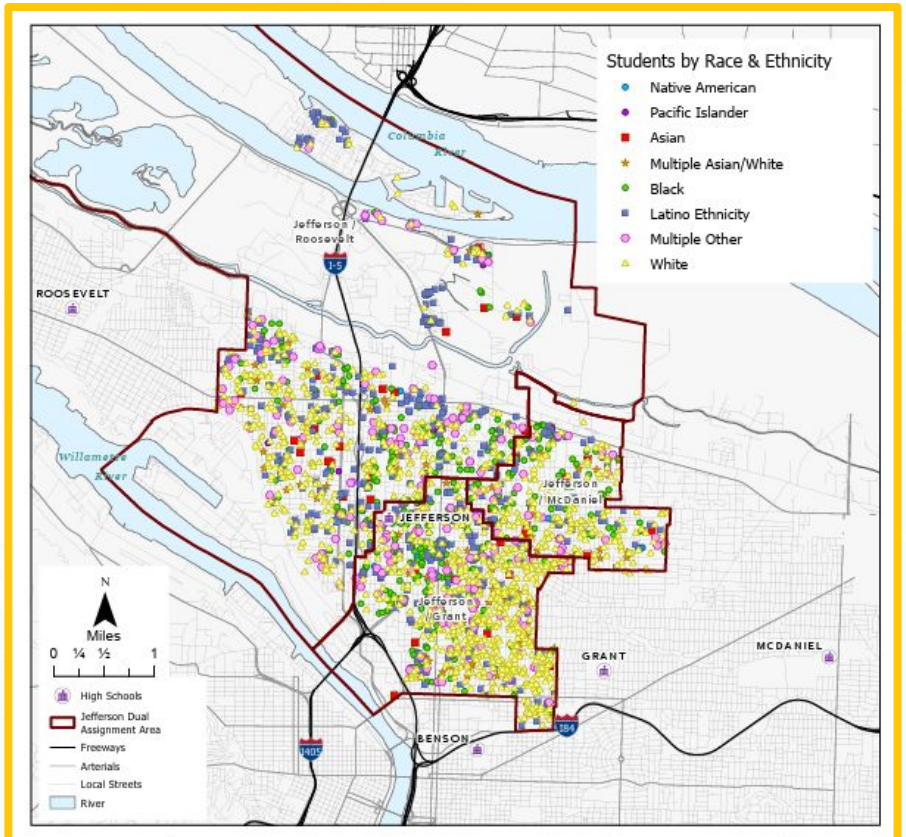
HS Students in Dual Assignment Zones



Students by High School

- Jefferson
- Benson
- Other
- Comprehensive Option

High School Type	Grade 9	Grade 10	Grade 11	Grade 12	Total Count
Jefferson HS	67	103	103	108	381
Benson HS	89	55	36	43	223
Other HS	43	66	118	195	422
Comprehensive Option	353	354	338	313	1358
Grand Total	552	578	595	659	2384

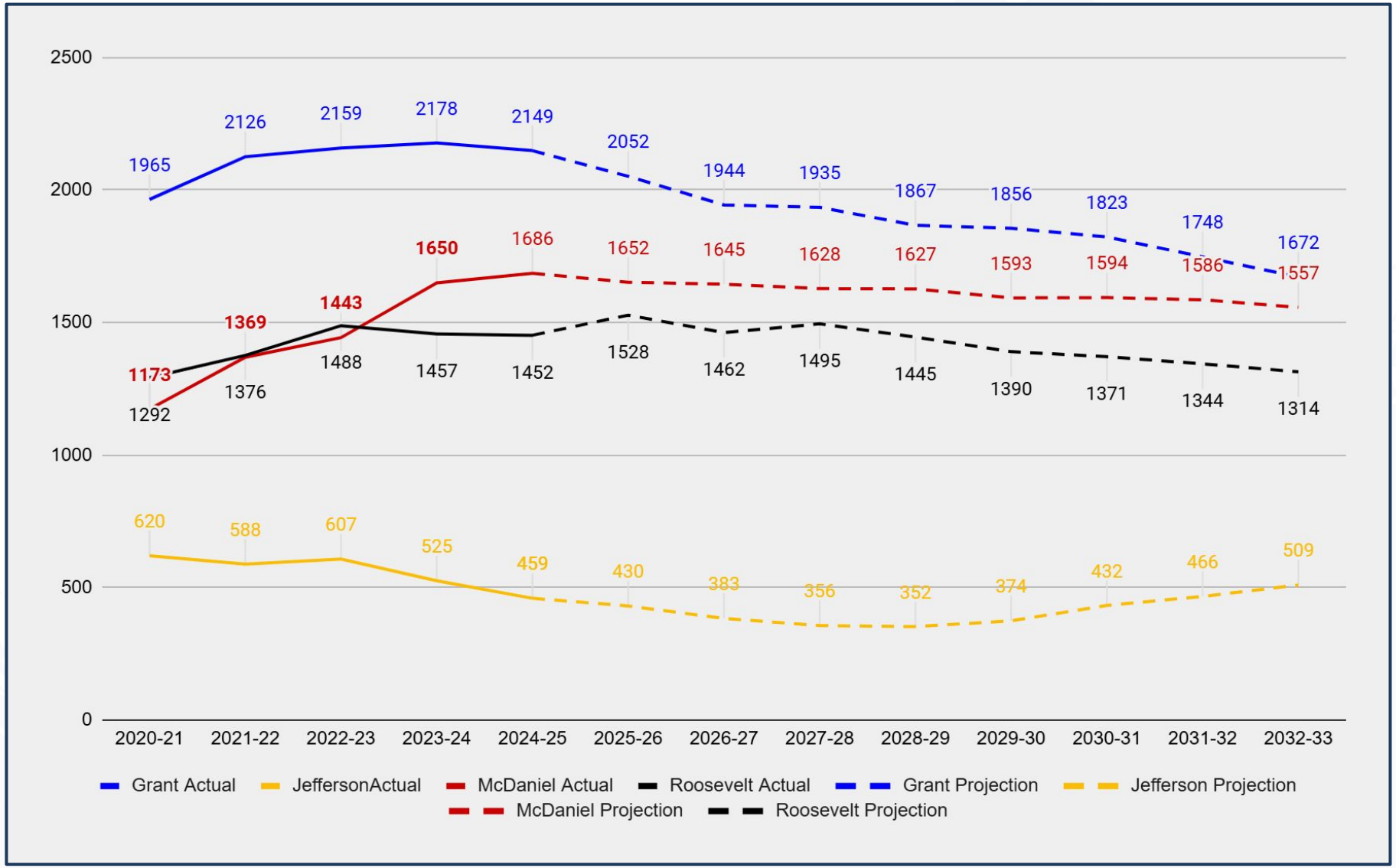


	Historically Underserved Race / Ethnicity					White / Asian			
Attending School	Black	Latino Ethnicity	Native American	Pacific Islander	Multiple	Asian	White	Asian/ White	Grand Total
Benson	44	63	0	0	18	6	85	7	223
Comprehensive Option	160	239	3	9	104	20	760	63	1358
Jefferson	178	82	1	3	40	4	69	4	381
Other	73	101	10	2	35	11	167	23	422
Grand Total	455	485	14	14	197	41	1081	97	2384

Students by Program

Students by Race & Ethnicity

Enrollment at Dual Assignment Schools



Path to Robust Enrollment

Marketing, Communications and Engagement Efforts

Research + Data Collection
Marketing enrollment trends research

Deploy Materials
Jefferson marketing toolkit development

Drive Awareness
Media and advertisement campaign

Drive Awareness
Information sessions at JHS and school visits

Spring 2025 | **Summer 2025** | **Fall 2025** | **Winter 2026**

Drive Awareness
Co-Host events with community Partners

Board Direction
Recommendation to the board

Dual Assignment Community Dialogue

Strengthen enrollment at Jefferson during modernization and ensure robust long-term enrollment

Dual Assignment Community Engagement Timeline

Summer 2025 → **Fall 2025** → **Winter 2025-26**

Review + Initiate

- ➔ Board presentation on current state of enrollment
- ➔ Plan for engagement

Engage + Develop

- ➔ Form advisory committee
- ➔ Three public meetings before Winter Break
- ➔ Develop scenarios

Study + Recommend

- ➔ Analyze scenarios + feedback
- ➔ Recommend action to increase JHS enrollment to Board

Continue District and school efforts to increase enrollment at Jefferson

Board discussion

